PRINTABLE ESCAPE GAME · 16 PAGES

Christmas Escape Room

The Bell Vault: one story, two levels (ages 6-9 and 10+). No phone or internet needed.

PRINTABLE · INSTANT DOWNLOAD

GM's Digital Creations

READ THIS FIRST

Game Master Guide

Everything you need to run a 45-minute Christmas escape game at home, in a classroom or at a party.

HOW THE GAME WORKS

Juniper the elf locked the sleigh bells in the Bell Vault and forgot the 4-digit code. Players solve 4 clues. Each clue gives one digit. The 4 digits, in order, open the vault.

Two levels, one story. Every clue comes in Level 1 (ages 6-9: counting, pictures, simple codes) and Level 2 (ages 10+: shift cipher, symbol math, a maze, a logic grid). Both levels of a clue lead to the SAME digit, so brothers, sisters and cousins of different ages play together and can check each other.

Players: 1 to 12, in teams of 2 to 4. Time: about 45 minutes.

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] This PDF, printed (Letter or A4)
- [ ] Pencils and a few crayons
- [ ] Scissors and tape
- [ ] 5 envelopes per team (or folded paper)
- [ ] A timer or clock
- [ ] No phone, app, QR code or internet

Printing: ink-light pages (white paper, thin lines). Every puzzle works in black and white. On A4, choose "Fit to page".

Play it again: the other level makes a new game, so a team that played Level 1 this year can try Level 2 next time.

Big group? Print one set of clue sheets and lock tags per team and race to the vault.

SET UP IN 10 MINUTES

1. Print pages 3 to 14 and 16. Each team gets the clue sheets for its level (Level 1 or Level 2). Mixed-age team? Give it both.
2. Make one set of 5 envelopes per team. Cut out the lock tags (page 13, one page per team) and tape one on each envelope: Clue 1, Clue 2, Clue 3, Clue 4 and the Vault.
3. Put each clue's sheets in its envelope, and the Vault sheet (page 12) in the Clue 1 envelope so teams record digits as they go. The certificates (page 16) go in the Vault envelope.
4. Cut out the hint cards (page 14) and keep them with the Answer Key (page 15). Players never see page 15.
5. Read the mission letter (page 3) out loud, start the 45-minute timer and hand out the Clue 1 envelope.
6. When a team finds a digit, they write it on the next envelope's lock tag and show you. Check it on the Answer Key. Right? They open that envelope. Not yet? They keep trying or ask for a hint.
7. Each team may ask for 3 hint cards. When the 4-digit vault code is right, read the victory note on page 15 and let the team open the Vault envelope: their certificates are inside.

YOUR MISSION

The Bell Vault

Read this letter out loud to start the game.

Dear Workshop Helpers,

It is Christmas Eve and I have made a terrible mistake. I locked the sleigh bells in the Bell Vault to keep them safe... and now I cannot remember the code! Without the bells, the sleigh cannot fly tonight.

I am a careful elf, so I hid 4 clues around the workshop. Each clue gives one digit of the code. Solve all 4, put the digits in order and the vault will open.

Please hurry. The sleigh leaves in 45 minutes!

Your friend, Juniper (the youngest elf in the workshop)

YOUR TEAM

Team name _____

Players _____

Level (circle): LEVEL 1 or LEVEL 2 or BOTH

Start time _____ Escape time _____

VAULT CODE TRACKER: WRITE EACH DIGIT AS YOU FIND IT

CLUE 1	CLUE 2	CLUE 3	CLUE 4

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

The Gift Tag Code

Juniper wrote the first digit on a gift tag in her secret number code. Each number stands for one letter.

THE CODE KEY: A IS 1, B IS 2, C IS 3...

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Warm up: decode this tag first

WRITE A LETTER IN EACH BOX

5 12 6

Juniper's secret tag

THE SECRET WORD IS A NUMBER

19 5 22 5 14

The first digit is

Bonus fun: write your own name in Juniper's code

CLUE 1

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Scrambled Note

Juniper hid the first digit in a shift code: every letter moved the same number of steps along the alphabet.

THE NOTE FOUND UNDER THE WORKBENCH

W K H I L U V W

G L J L W L V V H Y H Q

Signed: M X Q L S H U

How to crack it

1. You know the note is from Juniper, so the signature MXQLSHU must spell JUNIPER. Count how many steps J moved to become M.
2. Every letter in the note moved by that same number. Move each letter BACK that many steps (after A, go round to Z).
3. Use the shift strip below: write the real letter under each code letter, then read the note.

SHIFT STRIP

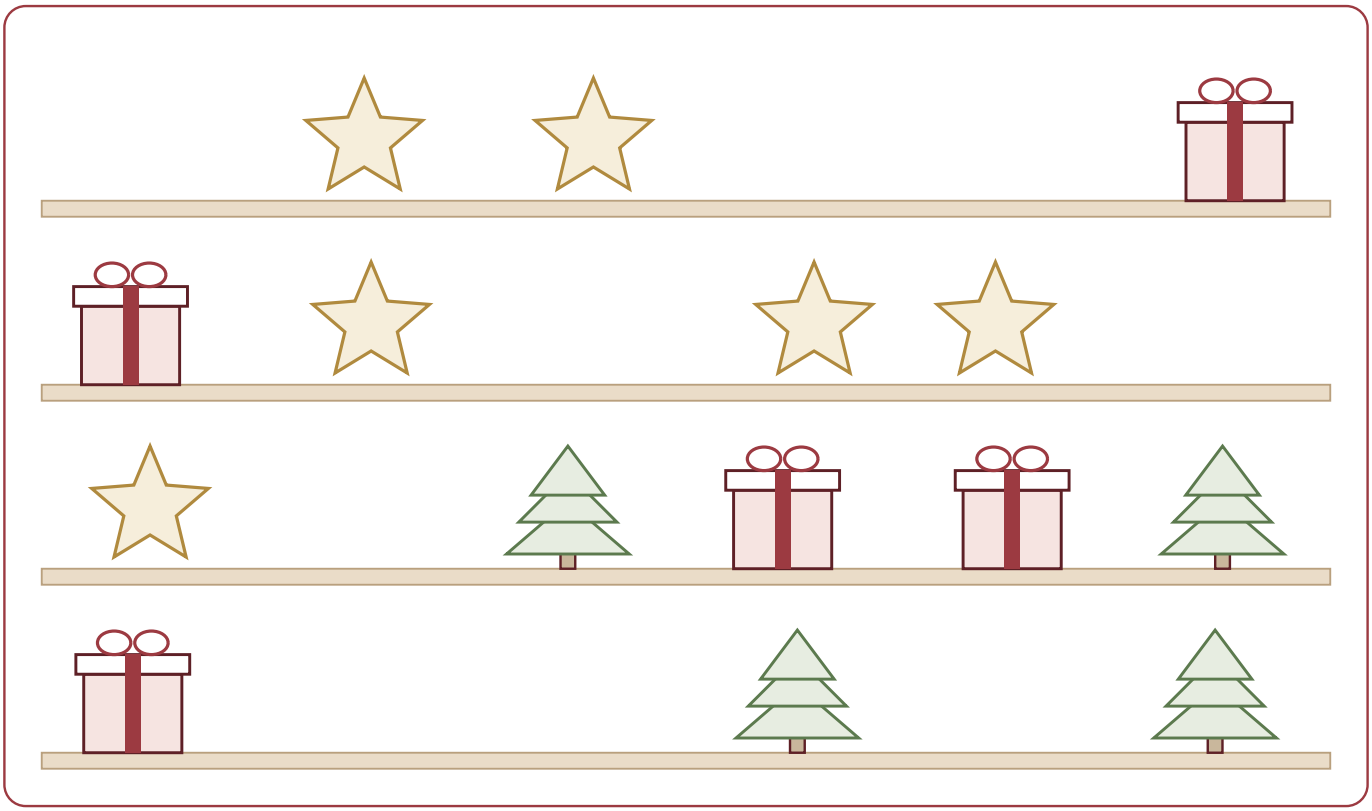
A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z

The first digit is ☐

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6–9

Count the Workshop Shelf

Juniper says: count everything on my shelf, then do my sum to find the second digit.



Trees ☐

Gifts ☐

Stars ☐

Juniper's sum

☐ trees + ☐ gifts − ☐ stars = ☐ digit 2

Tip: put a tiny dot on each picture as you count it so you never count one twice.

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

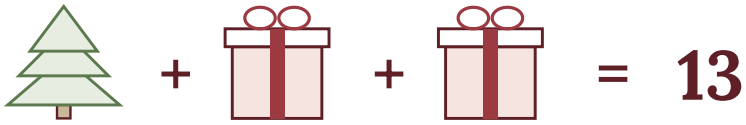
Workshop Symbol Sums

Each picture stands for a different whole number. Work out all three, then solve Juniper's last line.

LINE 1



LINE 2



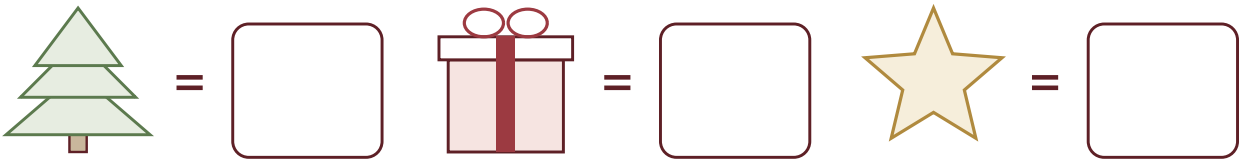
LINE 3



JUNIPER'S LAST LINE

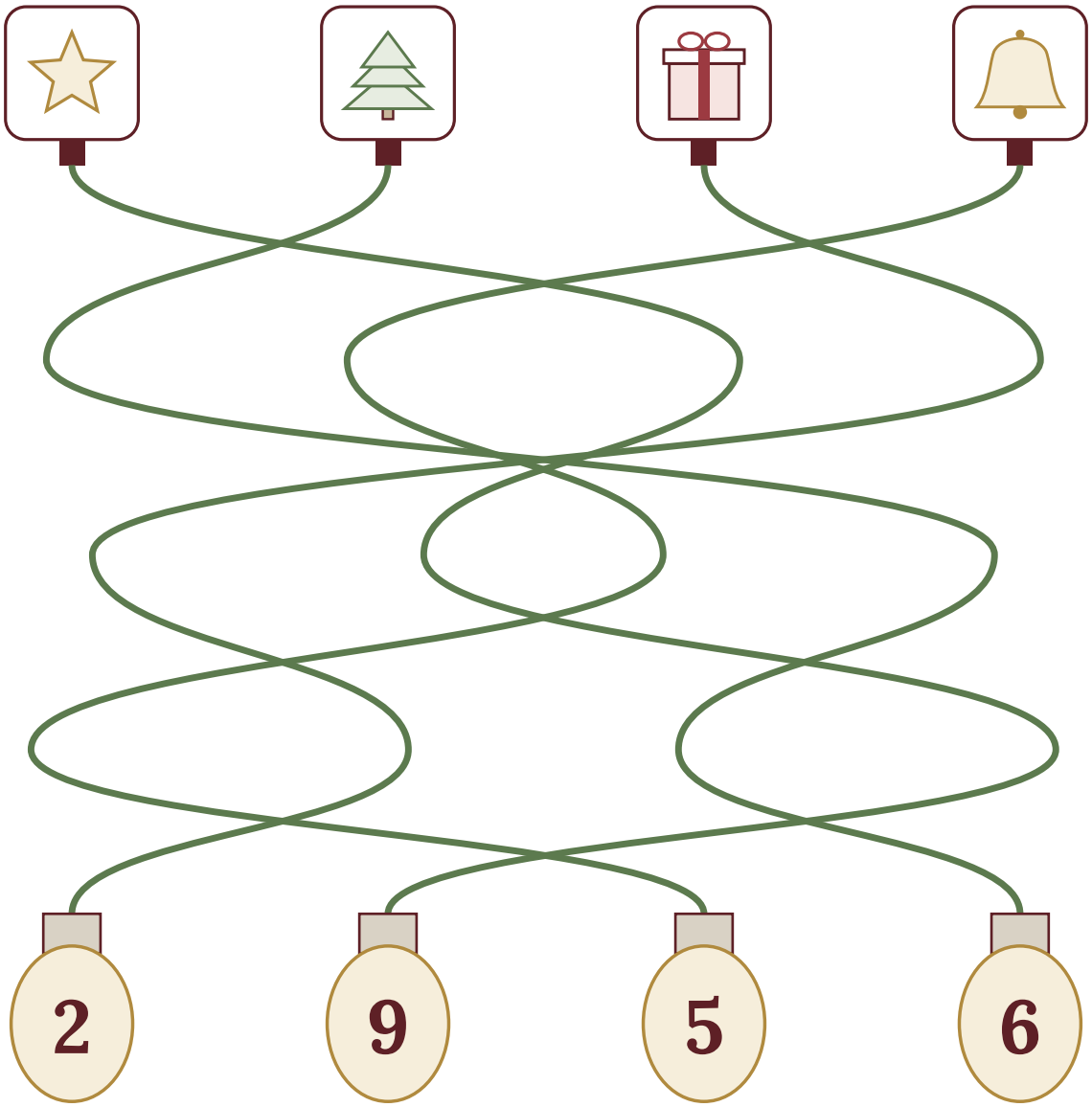


WRITE WHAT EACH PICTURE IS WORTH



The Tangled Lights

The workshop lights are all tangled up! Follow the strand from the STAR plug to find which bulb it lights.



Trace it with your finger or a crayon. The number on that bulb is the third digit.

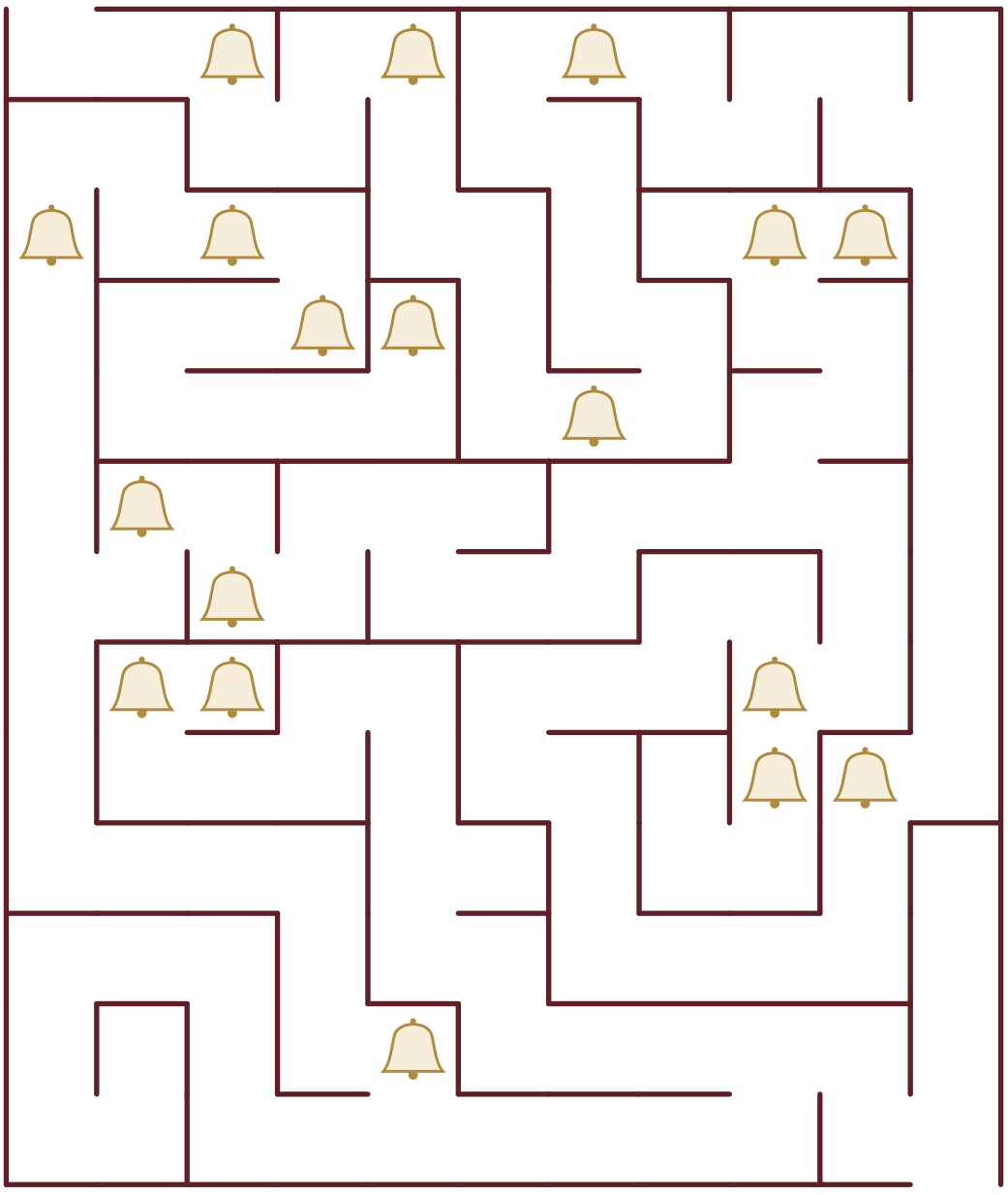
The third digit is ☐

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Bell Maze

Find the only path from the Workshop door to the Sleigh. Count the bells ON your path; bells in dead ends do not count.

START: WORKSHOP DOOR



FINISH: THE SLEIGH

The third digit is ☐

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

Snowflake Sudoku

Fill the grid so every row, every column and every thick-lined box has 1, 2, 3 and 4 once each.

1			
		1	2
2			3
	3		1

HOW TO PLAY

Start with a row or box that already has 3 numbers: the missing one is easy to spot. Write in pencil so you can rub out. When the grid is full, look at the square with the gold snowflake: that number is the fourth digit.

The fourth digit is ☐

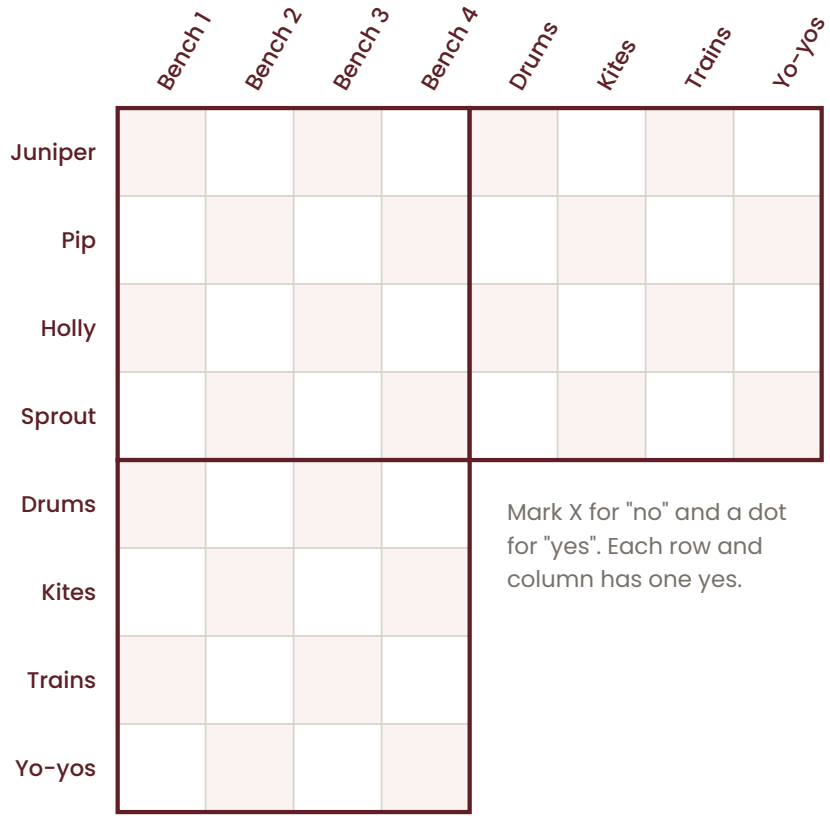
LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Elf Workbench Puzzle

Four elves work at benches 1 to 4. Each makes one toy. Use the clues to find which bench builds the trains.

JUNIPER'S CLUES

1. Pip works at bench 1, and Pip does not make yo-yos.
2. Holly makes the drums.
3. Holly works at the bench between Pip and Juniper.
4. The kites and the yo-yos are both made at odd-numbered benches.
5. Juniper works right next to the elf who builds the trains.



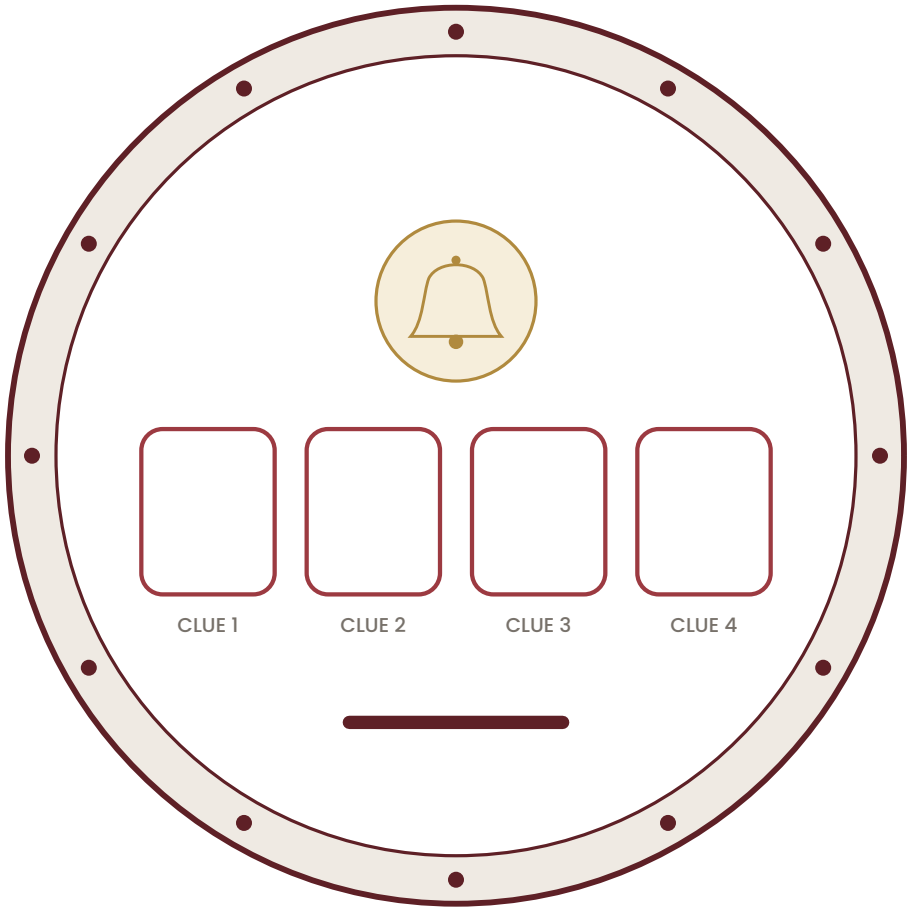
Mark X for "no" and a dot for "yes". Each row and column has one yes.

Trains: bench number ☐

THE FINAL LOCK

Open the Bell Vault

Write the 4 digits in order. Show the Game Master. If the code is right, the vault swings open!



WRONG CODE? CHECK THESE BEFORE YOU ASK FOR A HINT

- [ ] Are the digits in clue order: Clue 1, Clue 2, Clue 3, Clue 4?
- [ ] Mixed-age team? Both levels of a clue give the same digit. Compare your answers.
- [ ] Recount Clue 2 and retrace Clue 3 slowly: those are the easiest to slip on.
- [ ] Still stuck? Ask the Game Master for a hint card (3 per team).
- [ ] Code right? Open the Vault envelope together: your Escape Expert certificates are inside. Write your escape time on page 3!

GAME MASTER: CUT OUT

Envelope Lock Tags

Cut out and tape one tag to each envelope. A team writes its digit on the tag and shows the Game Master to unlock it.

Clue 1

Open me first!

The Gift Tag Code / The Scrambled Note

Clue 2

Locked: write the digit from Clue 1

Count the Workshop Shelf / Symbol Sums

Clue 3

Locked: write the digit from Clue 2

The Tangled Lights / The Bell Maze

Clue 4

Locked: write the digit from Clue 3

Snowflake Sudoku / Elf Workbench Puzzle

The Bell Vault

Locked: write the 4-digit vault code

Inside: Escape Expert certificates (page 16)

Game Master

Hint cards + answer key

Players: do not open

GAME MASTER ONLY

Hint Cards

Game Master: cut out and hand over one hint at a time (3 per team). Fold each card so Hint 2 stays hidden until it is needed.

CLUE 1 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1

Find 19 in the code key. Which letter is above it?

fold here

HINT 2

The secret word is a number word with 5 letters.

CLUE 1 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1

J to M is 3 steps forward. So go 3 steps BACK for every letter.

fold here

HINT 2

W goes back to T, K to H, H to E: the first word is THE.

CLUE 2 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1

Count one kind of picture at a time, and dot each one.

fold here

HINT 2

There are more stars than trees. Did you take the stars away last?

CLUE 2 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1

Line 1 has three of the same picture. Divide 15 by 3.

fold here

HINT 2

Once you know the tree, line 2 gives the gift, then line 3 gives the star.

CLUE 3 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1

Put a crayon on the star plug and never lift it off the strand.

fold here

HINT 2

The star strand crosses the others. Stay on the same line at every crossing.

CLUE 3 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1

Mazes are easier from the end: try starting at the sleigh.

fold here

HINT 2

Shade dead ends as you find them. Only bells on the open path count.

CLUE 4 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1

Row 2 already has 1 and 2. Which two numbers are missing?

fold here

HINT 2

The snowflake square's row has 2 and 3, and its column has 1.

CLUE 4 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1

Clues 1 and 3 together tell you where Holly sits.

fold here

HINT 2

Pip makes kites or trains, but trains must sit next to Juniper.

GAME MASTER ONLY

Answer Key

Game Master only: keep this page hidden from players.

CLUE	LEVEL 1 (AGES 6-9)	LEVEL 2 (AGES 10+)	DIGIT
1	5 12 6 = ELF; 19 5 22 5 14 = SEVEN	Signature MXQLSHU = JUNIPER (shift 3). Note reads THE FIRST DIGIT IS SEVEN	7
2	4 trees + 5 gifts - 6 stars = 3	Tree 5, gift 4, star 2, so 5 + 2 - 4 = 3	3
3	The star plug's strand ends at bulb 9	The one path from door to sleigh passes 9 bells (see map)	9
4	The gold snowflake square is 4	Bench 1 Pip kites, 2 Holly drums, 3 Juniper yo-yos, 4 Sprout trains	4

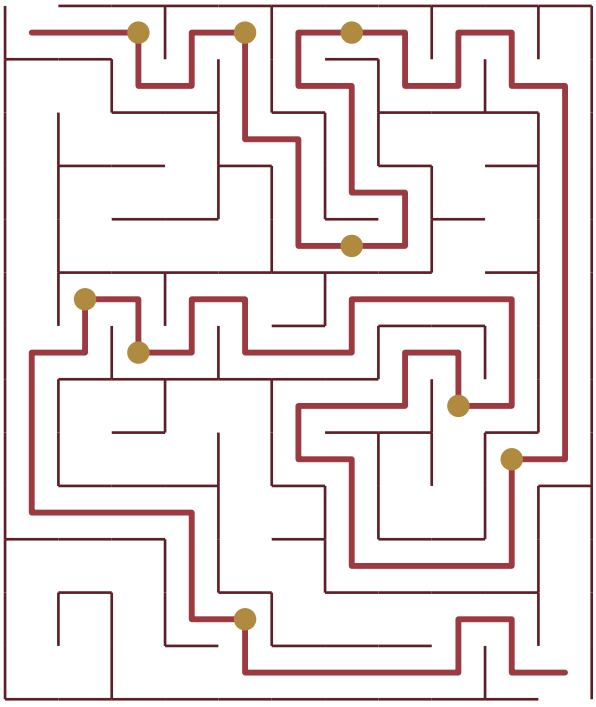
Vault code: 7 3 9 4

Both levels give the same 4 digits.

Sudoku solution

1	2	3	4
3	4	1	2
2	1	4	3
4	3	2	1

Maze solution path



Gold dots = the 9 bells on the path. Bells in dead ends do not count.

Read aloud when the vault opens:

"The vault door creaks open and there they are: the sleigh bells, shining and ringing! Juniper hugs every one of you. Thanks to your team, the sleigh flies tonight. You are official Workshop Escape Experts!"

TWO PER PAGE: PRINT ONE FOR EVERY PLAYER

Escape Expert Certificates

THE BELL VAULT

Certified Escape Expert

This certifies that

_____

opened the Bell Vault and saved Christmas Eve.

LEVEL _____ ESCAPE TIME _____ DATE _____

Signed: Juniper, Keeper of the Bells

THE BELL VAULT

Certified Escape Expert

This certifies that

_____

opened the Bell Vault and saved Christmas Eve.

LEVEL _____ ESCAPE TIME _____ DATE _____

Signed: Juniper, Keeper of the Bells



You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations